3} Fetal Heart Rate Evaluation

Goals:

Objectives:

By the end of this procedure, the student nurse should be able to:

Outlines:

- ☞ Introduction.
- ☞ Definition.
- ☞ Locations.
- ☞ Equipment.
- ☞ Procedure.

Introduction:

The fetal heart rate is an essential observation of fetal wellb eing. It may be measured to obtain baseline data and to detect changes in the physical condition of the unborn child. The fetal heart rate is assessed at every abdominal examination and after any investigation.

Definition:

It is a method used to diagnose the fetal condition.

Normal range of F.H.R

- ☞ **The normal** F.H.R is ranged from 120 to 160 b/m.

- **Bradycardia** is indicated by a heart rate less than 120 b/m.
- **Tachycardia** is indicated by a heart rate more than 160 b/m.

Objectives:

1- To diagnose pregnancy.

2- To assure the determined position and presentation of the fetus.

3- To detect that the fetus is alive.

4- To diagnose fetal distress and/or uterine fetal death.

5- To diagnose multiple pregnancy.

6- To determine the progress of labor.

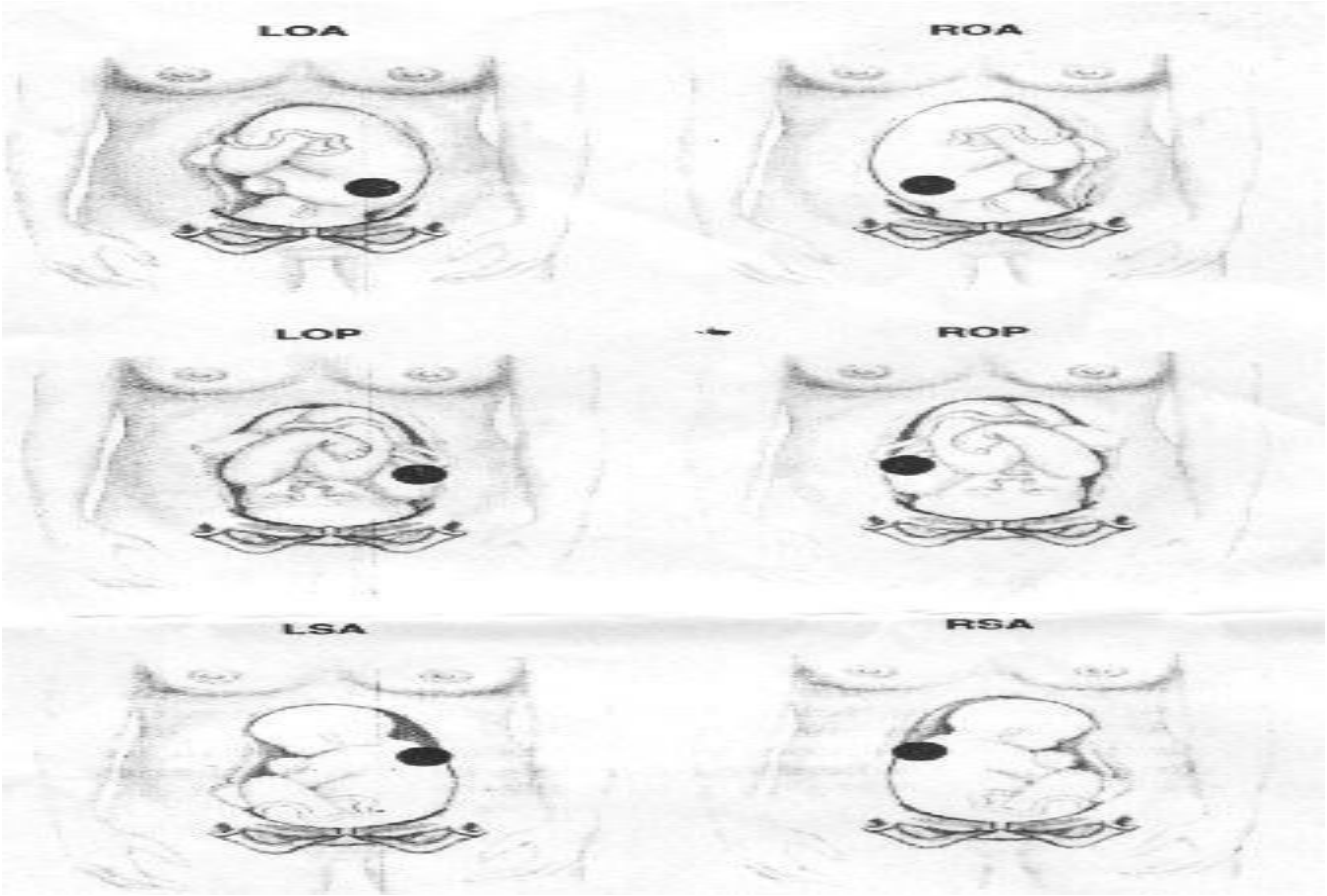
Equipment:

1- Fetal stethoscope (Pinard's stethoscope).

2- Ultrasound techniques (Doppler).

3- The sonicaid.

Location of measuring the fetal heart rate



https://m.media-mazon.com/images/I/513GsXOT9+L._UF1000,1000_QL80_.jpg

Auscultation of Fetal Heart Rate

Action	First Trial		Second Trial	
	Done	Note Done	Done	Note Done
1- Examine the previous recording of the F.H.R of the F.H.R of the fetus				
2- Explain the procedure to the woman.				
3-Screen the bed, drape the woman and expose her abdomen.				
4-Place the woman in dorsal position with legs straight.				
5-Wash hands with warm water.				
6-Gather the equipment.				
7-Use the abdominal grips to locate position of the fetus.				
Using fetal stethoscope (Pinard's):				
A- Clean the abdominal piece of Pinard's stethescope with alcohol wipes.				

B. Place the bell of the fetoscope over the fetal back with the head plate pressed against forehead to add bone conduction to the sound coming through the earpieces. - More the fetoscope until locate where the sound is loudest. - Use forehead to maintain pressure during ausscultation to enhancl the faint fetal heart souds.				
Fetoscope with head attachment				
C. Place ear on the earpieces rest of the feto-stethoscope, - Remove fingers so that the ear, stethoscope abdomen is in direct contact.				
D – With one hand, palpate the mother's radial pulse to verify that the fetal heart rate is what is actually heard if her pulse is synchronized with the sounds from the fetoscope, or doppler tranesducer, try another location for the fetal heart.				

E- Count the baseline fetal heart rate for 30 to 60 seconds between contraction. - Assessment during a contraction may clarify findindings. - But auscultation is difficult during contractions.				
F- Note reassuring signs that suggest the fetus is erating labor well: a- An average rate of 110 to 160 beats minute. b- Regular rhythm. c- Acceleration from the baseline rate. d- No baseline rate.				
G- Note nonreassring signs, and make more frequent assessments. Notify the physician or nurse-midwife for further evaluation. a- Heart rate outside normal limits. Unexplained tachy cardia or brody cardia for 10 minutes or longer. b- Irregular rhythm. c- Gradual or abrupt decreas in rate.				
Use of sonicaid				

A- Lubricate the area over the fetal back using a thin layer of jelly				
B- Put the sonicaid over the lubricated area				
C- Turn on the sonicaid and gently move it along the skin of the mother's abdomen. - Listen for the sound of blood flowing through the arteries.				
C- Count the fetal heart rate for 1 minute.				
D-Wipe off the gel				
-Using a Doppler ultrasonic flow meter: -				
A- Place a small amount of transmission gel over the mother's abdomen where the back of the fetus was previously located.				
B- Turn on the Doppler ultrasonic flow meter and gently move it along the skin of the mother's abdomen. - Listen for the sound of blood flowing through the arteries.				
C- Count the fetal heart rate for 1 minute.				
D-Wipe off the gel				
8- Discuss the findings with the mother if appropriate.				

9- Drape the exposed abdomen.				
10- Replace equipment				
11- Wash hands.				
Procedure score				
Date				

Student name **Instructor name**